# Playmaker step 3l: playing levels and roster modes

Both features are in and live. No rule of play changed: only which ratings the cards carry and how teams are picked. No simulations were run; everything was verified with unit tests and browser checks.

## Summary

**Tests:** 37 new in `tests/test_levels_3l.py`, all passing. In the full suite at the time, 477 passed and 1 failed: the step 3k setup timing test (6.86 s against a 5 s limit during the 33-minute run). Run alone it passed at the same speed with and without the step 3l changes (8.4 s v 8.7 s for the whole test), so the failure was machine load. (Step 3m has since retired that test.)

**Bug fixed from step 3k:** the setup logic was never added to the browser version of the site, so the computer couldn't place its pieces there.

## Places changed from printed position to slot

Most of the audit came down to one change: each team's cards are stored in slot order, so whatever reads a player's number reads the slot.

- **Piece numbers:** O1 to O5 and X1 to X5 follow the slot, so a centre in slot 4 plays as O4.
- **Matchups by number:** Rookie's matchup by number and the setup logic's man-to-man by number follow the slot.
- **Hunt and protect:** the O1 v X1 pairings follow the slot.
- **Logs:** each player is recorded with card, slot and growth tag.
- **Scout report:** player numbers are slot numbers.
- **Cards:** each card records its slot and whether it plays out of position; the card panel and the piece's screen-reader label say "playing the 4".
- **Computer:** its view of each card carries the slot.
- **Draft computer:** gives up a little for a pick that plays out of position.

Kept on printed position on purpose:

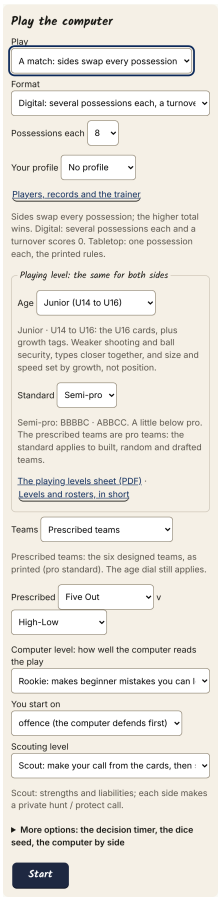
- **Scout report wording:** "unusual for the position" compares a card with others of its printed position.
- **Rookie's card reading:** Rookie judges a card by the position printed on it.
- **Old custom-team route:** expected one card per position, PG to C (step 3m has since retired it into the slot builder).

## Legal rosters

Counting which card goes in which slot. The no-flex numbers match the designer's.

| Standard | No flex | With flex |
|---|---|---|
| Pro | 159,375 | 1,369,375 |
| Semi-pro | 109,375 | 939,375 |
| Amateur | 46,875 | 386,875 |

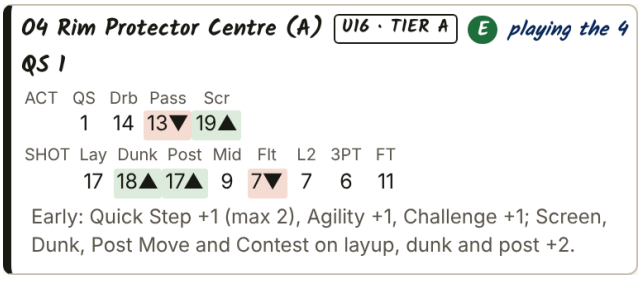
## Screenshots (412 × 915, no sideways scroll)



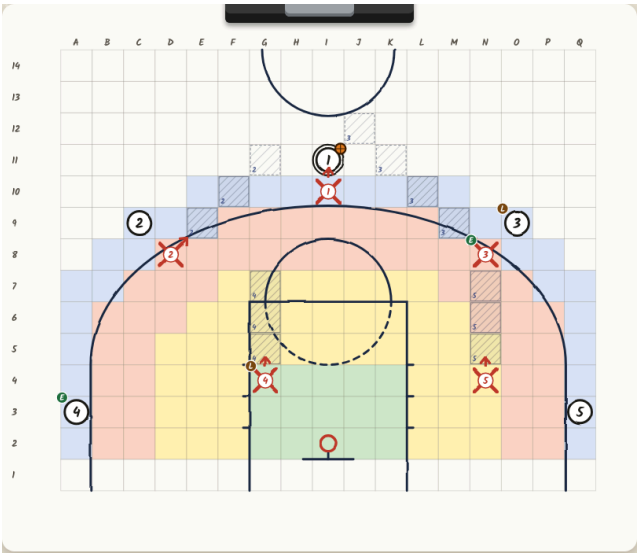

The new-game screen with the two dials




The draft board




A junior card: U16 label, Early tag, playing the 4



The board with E and L growth badges

## Calls made where the spec was open

1. **No rules page.** The app had no "Pick teams" paragraph to replace. Instead, a "Levels and rosters" panel on the new-game screen uses the sheet's wording, next to a link to the PDF.
2. **Jobs used pro numbers.** The four jobs in coherent deals and the draft were judged from the pro card. (Step 3m now judges them at the playing age.)
3. **When growth tags turn over.** "Setup begins" means after the Scout-level hunt/protect call, which is made with the opponent's tags face down. With two humans on one screen, both teams' tags stay

face down until then.

4. **Random deal for one side only.** The other team is whichever prescribed team is chosen in the picker.
5. **"Challenge me" is a button.** It deals pure random rosters for both teams; the "Kind" setting defaults to Coherent.
6. **Shared cards.** Draft teams pick from one pool. Random deals gave each team its own deck. (Step 3m now deals from one pool.)
7. **Handicap.** The different-standard-per-side option showed only in "Build your teams". (Step 3m added it to the draft screen.)